MARVELS

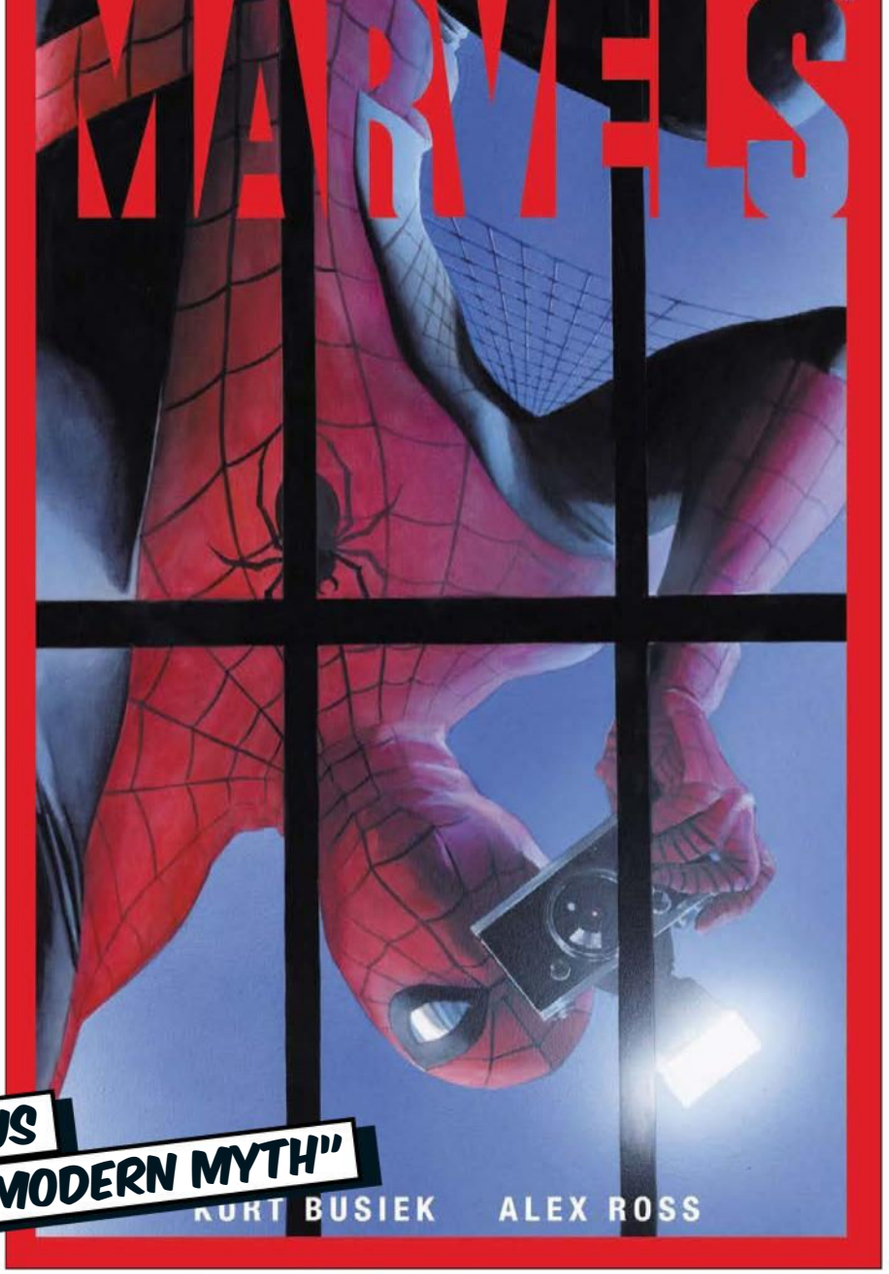
Details **Originally published** Marvels #0-4.2 (1994) **Publisher** Marvel
Writer Kurt Busiek **Artist** Alex Ross **Collected in** Marvels
Available digitally Comixology

Although it's often hailed for its chronicle of the Marvel Universe, what truly makes *Marvels* stand out is its celebration of what makes comics great.

Kurt Busiek's ability to analyse the dynamic between superheroes and ordinary society without reverting to cynicism gives us a thoughtful and heartfelt take on Marvel's narrative history. Through the viewpoint of photographer Phil Sheldon, we see the stress that living among constant superhuman conflict and destruction places on everyday people, as well as the awe that these larger-than-life figures inspire.

Ross's photorealistic images of a colossal Galactus hovering over a city where cars and buildings look like toys or a silent Spider-Man crawling insect-like up a wall make the characters seem inhuman, even godlike.

They remind us that reading comics places us among creatures of modern myth, which should never be taken for granted – but rather, should be marvelled at.



"READING COMICS PLACES US AMONG CREATURES OF MODERN MYTH"

